

MATRIX-GRID • RENDERING JANK

The grid that moved after it painted.

`matrix-grid` drew its columns from its own cell text. When the web font landed a frame after first paint, every column re-solved and every cell slid sideways — with nothing overflowing for a fit gate to catch.

WHAT WAS MOVING

Column widths were a function of the font that had not loaded yet.

Measured, not inferred

Same deck, same Studio, fonts blocked against fonts allowed. Blocked, the columns never moved.

The five columns moved

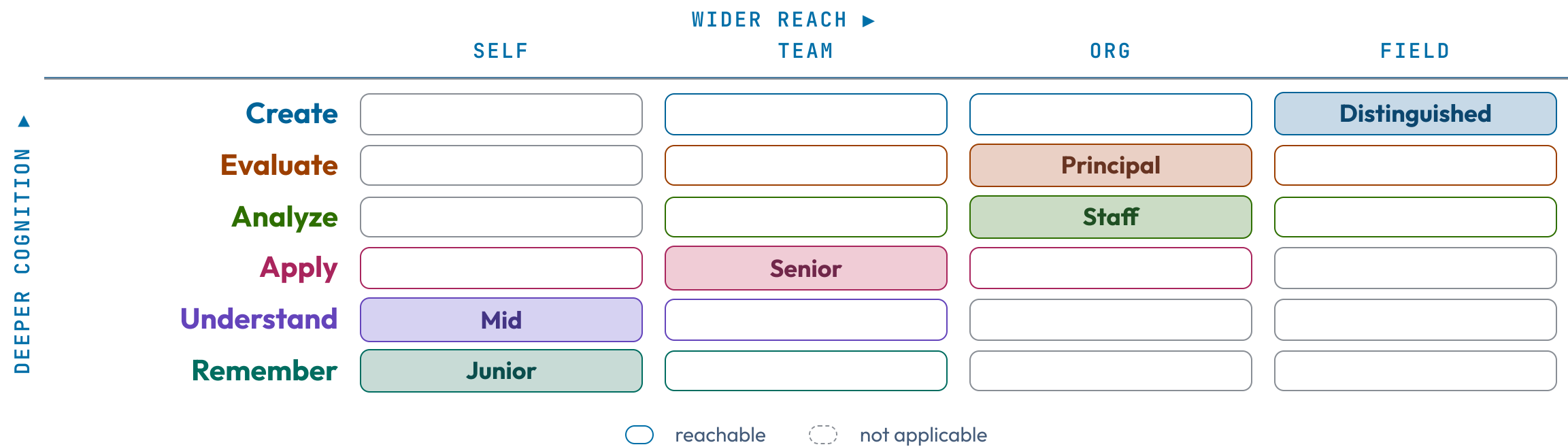
258.2 · 165.7 · 175.5 · 216.4 · 304.2 on first paint. 248.7 · 176.9 · 178.9 · 218.9 · 296.6 one frame later.

Invisible to every gate

The table was 1120px wide before and after. Nothing overflowed, so nothing was reported.

Your level is a cell, not a rung.

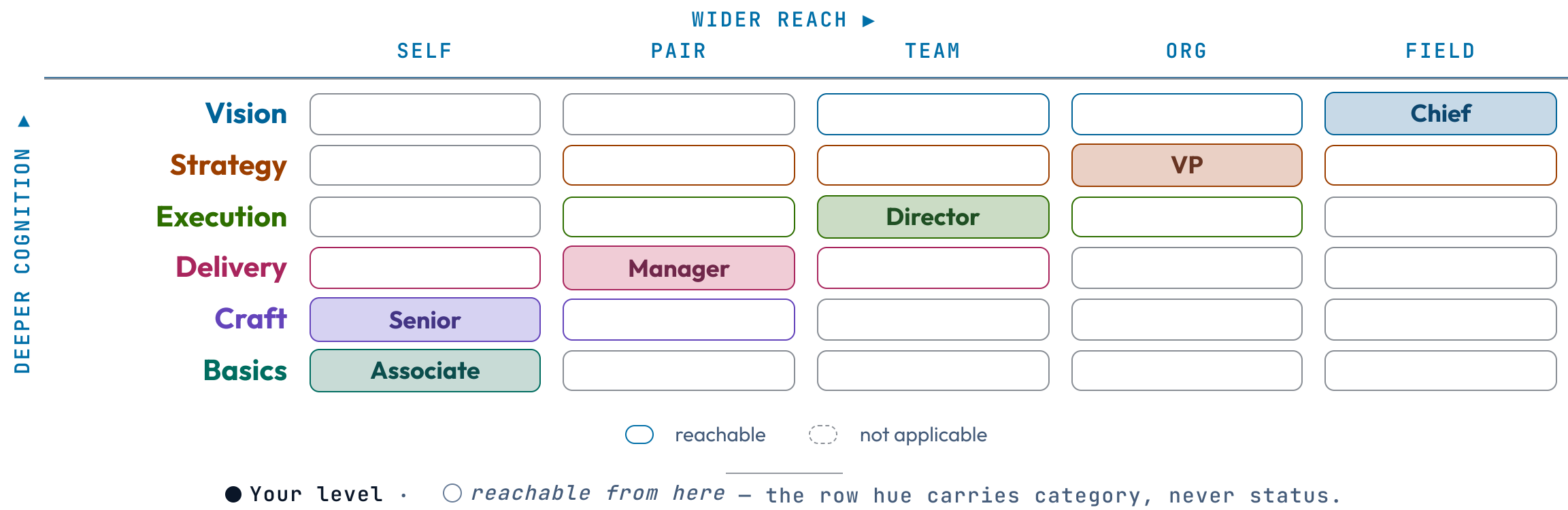
Every column is the same width, so the reach axis reads as equal steps.



● Your level . ○ where you can operate when called for – illustrative, placements vary by company.

Six categories by five columns is the grid's practical ceiling.

The widest label no longer buys width from its neighbors.



HOW IT IS HELD STILL

table-layout: fixed takes the text out of the geometry.

Geometry stops reading text

A fixed table divides its width by declaration. A late font changes the glyphs, never the column.

The sibling already did it

`roadmap`, the other table in this bucket, has been fixed-layout all along, for this reason.

Equal steps read truer

Under `auto` the reach axis was sized by the longest label: 165.7px against 304.2px, an 1.8x spread.

ONLY WIDE IS WIDE ENOUGH

Every narrower family still has to negotiate.

Measured as text advance

`scrollWidth` on a centered flex box misses the half that overflows left. A Range over the text node is the honest unit — and it reads `-25.2px` where `scrollWidth` reported a 2px rounding artifact.

Square fails like portrait, later

`--canvas-scale` raises the type as the box narrows. `Distinguished` clears its cell by `+75.9px` at wide, misses by `-25.2px` at square and `-44.5px` under `mode: sketch`.

The type floor is reached

`--fs-meta` is the floor of the twelve-token scale, so the step the narrow arm already takes is the last one available.

So only wide takes

fixed

Square, tall and strip keep `auto` and render byte-identically. The shift stays live there, and `scale-2xl` leaves wide only `+19.7px`.

RELATED

See also.

`roadmap` — the sibling table, fixed-layout since it shipped

`obligation-matrix` — rows × columns of pass/partial/exempt
status

`engineering/jank.md` — does the layout stay put as content grows